

Pāhala Large Capacity Cesspool Closure Project

Review of Amended Draft Environmental Information Document

County of Hawai'i

April 10, 2024

Pāhala Community Center



PĀHALA CESSPOOL CLOSURE MILESTONES/STATUS

2024 AOC revision

- ✓ Feasibility Evaluation Report (FER) – 60 days after Aug. 22, 2022 (10/21/22)
- ✓ Preliminary Engineering Report – 180 days after FER approval (Jul. 31, 2023)
- ✓ Draft Environmental Information Document – Nov. 14, 2023
- Revised Draft Environmental Information Document – March 2024
 - Public comment period March 15-April 15, 2024 **(We are here)**
- Final Environmental Information Document
 - Due July 30, 2024
- Implementation Plan – Due 30 days after EPA's approval of EID
- Large Capacity Cesspool closure – January 22, 2027

PURPOSE OF THIS MEETING

- Review the Amended Draft Environmental Information Document (EID), discuss the Preferred Alternative, and update the community on the status of this project.
- Allow community members the opportunity to give oral and/or written comment during the 30-day public comment period ending Monday, April 15. Members will be allowed to provide oral comments during and after this meeting.

WHAT IS AN ENVIRONMENTAL INFORMATION DOCUMENT (EID)

- The EID is an analysis of the environmental impacts of the proposed project alternatives, including the “no action” alternative.
- Describes the proposed project alternatives, project need, existing and surrounding land uses, existing environment, impacts, and mitigation measures.
- **The Revised Draft EID identifies the Preferred Alternative of a sewage treatment plant with a new collection system.**
- The Final EID will also include consultation (via consultation letter) with State and Federal agencies, County departments, public utilities, affected AOC properties, and other stakeholders.

ENVIRONMENTAL TOPICS COVERED IN THE EID

- The EID looks at the following environmental topics for the different treatment alternative options
 - Climate
 - Physiography (Topography, Geology, Soils)
 - Water Resources
 - Agricultural Lands
 - Natural Hazards (Sea Level Rise, Flood and Tsunami Threat, Hurricane and Wind Hazards, Seismic Hazard, Volcanic Hazard, Fire Hazard)
 - Flora & Fauna
 - Cultural, Historical, and Archaeological Resources
 - Air Quality & Odors
 - Noise
 - Energy and Natural Resources (Energy Sources, Water Resources, Land Use)
 - Roadways and Traffic
 - Hazardous Materials
 - Socioeconomics & Environmental Justice
 - Sustainability
 - Human Health and Safety
 - Unresolved issues

WASTEWATER TREATMENT OPTIONS

- **Alternative 1 – Package plant and new collection system**
- Alternative 2 – Package plant connected to the existing collection system
- Alternative 3 – Individual Wastewater System – Maintenance contract model program
- Alternative 4a – Individual Wastewater System – Operating permit model (County project)
- Alternative 4b – Individual Wastewater System – Operating permit model (Voucher program)

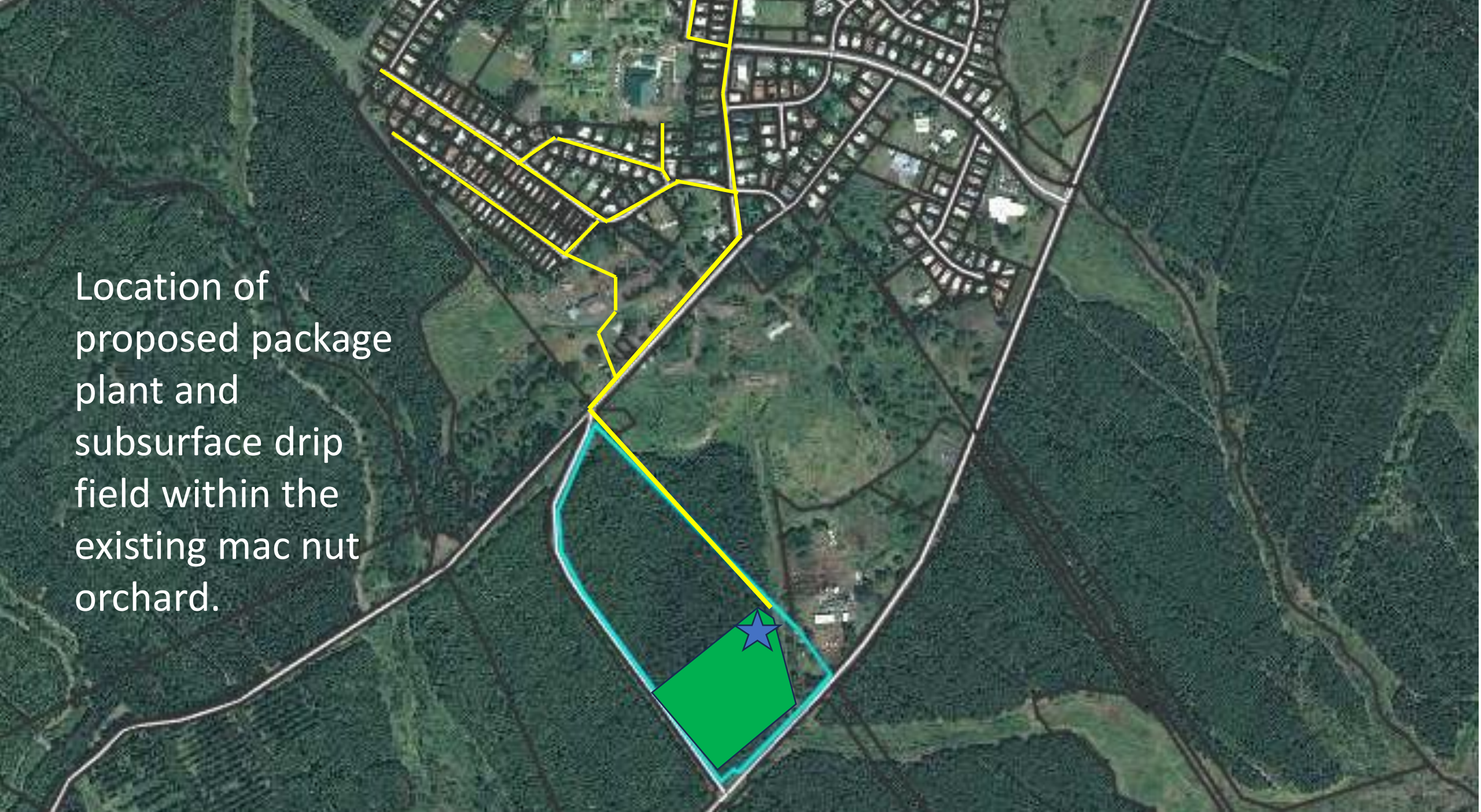
FACTORS IN SELECTING THE PREFERRED ALTERNATIVE

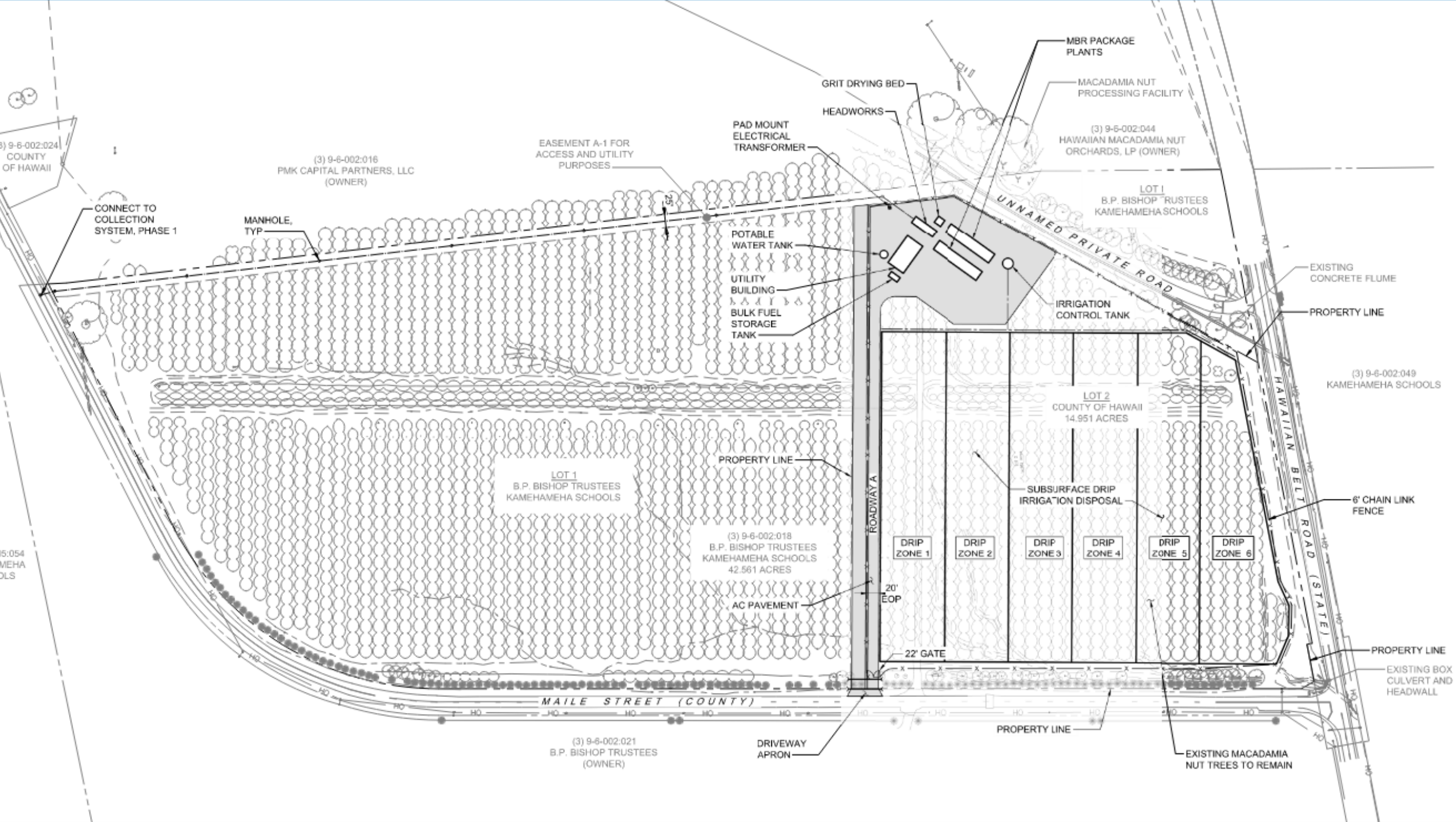
- Regulatory compliance
- Community Factor
- Environmental risks
- “The WWTP and new collection system will meet the goals of the Ka‘ū Community Development Plan to improve environmental management facilities of extending wastewater services within the Pāhala Community, which will protect the community health, safety, and the island’s environmental resources.”
- Cost

ACTIONS UNDER THE PREFERRED ALTERNATIVE 1

- Acquire a 14.9-acre portion of land from Kamehameha Schools. Construct a new secondary wastewater treatment and disposal facility.
- Construct a wastewater collection system, primarily within the public way, to collect and convey wastewater to the WWTP facility.
- Close and abandon two Large Capacity Cesspools.
- Abandon the existing wastewater collection system in place.

Location of
proposed package
plant and
subsurface drip
field within the
existing mac nut
orchard.





NEXT STEPS FOR PĀHALA

- We continue to be available for additional individual talk story sessions, Zooms, Q&As upon request.
- April 15 – Comment period on the Revised Draft EID closes.
- Compile community and consultation comments, finalize the Environmental Information Document, and submit to EPA.
- Upon approval of the Final EID by EPA, prepare Implementation Plan
- Complete design of the package plant and collection system, complete acquisition of easements and WWTP parcel, and work toward solicitation of bids for new collection system (2024) and WWTP (2025).
- Next District-Wide Outreach Meeting – August 2024

RESOURCES FOR MORE INFORMATION

- County website & online document repository
 - <https://www.dem.hawaiicounty.gov/projects/pahala-na-alehu-large-capacity-cesspool-closures>
- DEM YouTube channel
 - www.youtube.com/@cohenvironmentalmanagement
- EPA website
 - <https://www.epa.gov/uic/closure-cesspools-pahala-and-naalehu-administrative-order-consent-county-hawaii>
- Pāhala Revised Draft EID is available to check out from Pāhala Library

YOUR INPUT IS VALUABLE!

- If you have any questions, provide them to us tonight or email before April 15:

cohdem@hawaiiicounty.gov

- Reminder: Please sign in to ensure notification of future meetings

A vibrant sunset scene with the sun low on the horizon, casting a golden glow across a sky filled with wispy clouds. The sun's rays are visible breaking through the clouds. Below the horizon, the dark blue ocean with gentle waves is visible.

Mahalo for your participation in tonight's meeting – Questions?

<https://www.dem.hawaiicounty.gov/projects>

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